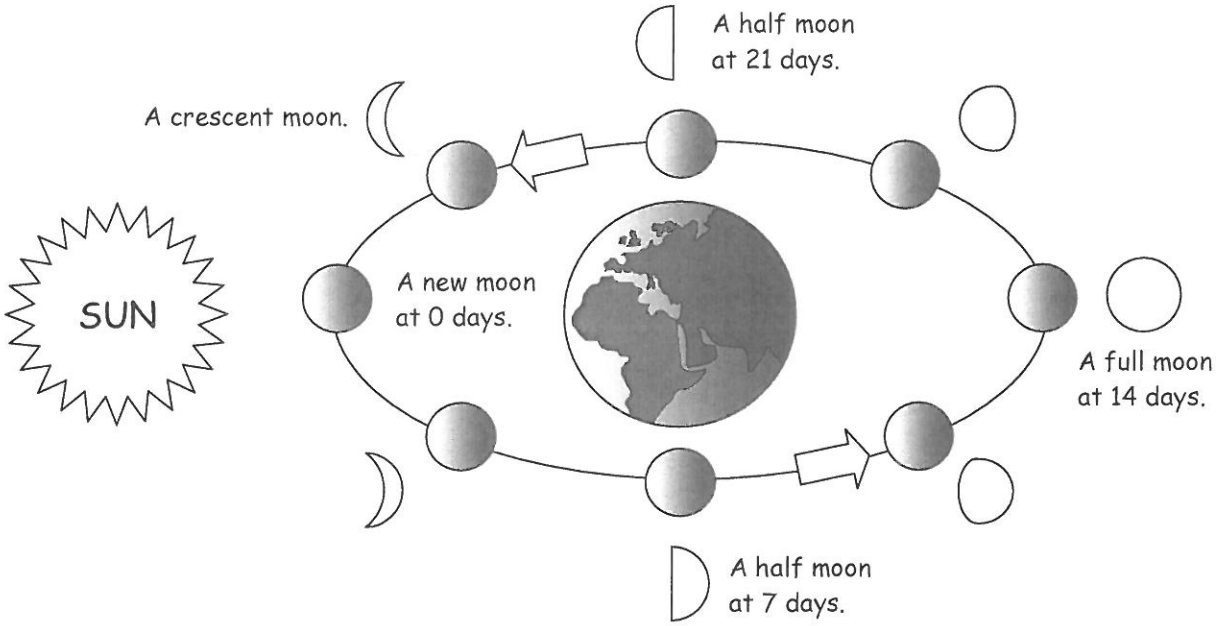
W.S.86. **The Moon and its phases.** Name .....

The Moon appears to change shape as it travels around the Earth. This happens because we only see the part of the Moon that reflects light from the Sun. The diagram below shows how this happens.



The changing appearance of the Moon is called its PHASES. The complete cycle from one new Moon to the next takes 29.5 days even though it only takes the Moon 27.3 days to completely orbit the Earth. The difference between these two times is because the Earth also slowly changes position as it orbits the Sun.

Gravity on the Moon.

The Moon has a much smaller mass than the Earth. This makes its pull of gravity six times smaller than the Earth's. This means that if you weigh 600N on Earth you would only weigh 100N on the Moon. This is why an astronaut feels very light on the Moon and can jump six times higher than they can on Earth. The bigger the mass of a planet the bigger its force of gravity.

Exercise - Complete the sentences below.

1) The changing appearance of the Moon is called its _ _ _ _ _ _

2) We cannot see the Moon when it is a _ _ _ Moon.

3) A _ _ _ _ Moon appears 14 days after a new Moon.

4) The Moon has a much smaller _ _ _ _ than the Earth.

5) You would weigh _ _ _ times less on the Moon.

6) The smaller a planet is the _ _ _ _ _ _ _ its gravitational force is.

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